प्रधानआयुक्त सीमा शुल्क)आयात(का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE PR. COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS (IMPORT),
तकनीकी अनुभाग, हवाई माल संकुल सहार, अंधेरी)पूर्व(, मुंबई- ४०० ०९९
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Date-02.09.2025

Minutes of the Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee meeting held on 26-08-2025

The monthly meeting of Permanent Trade Facilitation Committee (PTFC), for the month of August 2025, was held in the Conference Hall of ACC at 03:00 PM on 26.08.2025 and was chaired by Shri Manish Chandra, Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import), Co-chaired by Shri Hardeep Batra, Commissioner of Customs (Export) and Shri Nilank Kumar Commissioner of Customs (General). The following officers and representatives participated in the meeting:

S.No.	Name & Designation	Organization
1	Shri Tagadi Manjunath Addl. Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
2	Shri N. Pandiyaraj, Joint Commissioner of Customs (Import)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
3	Smt. Daribha Lyndem, Joint Commissioner of Customs (Export)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
4	Shri G L Narasimham, Deputy Commissioner of Customs (Technical Cell)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
5	Shri Rajesh Ramlal Solanki, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (SIIB(I))	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
6	Shri M. Sree Harsha, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
7	Shri K. Poddar, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Import Shed)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
8	Shri I Ramalingeswara Rao, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Group VA)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
9	Shri Jai Singh Rathore, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Export E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
10	Shri. Kiran Vaidya, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (TSK and Group)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
11	Smt. Jolly Koshy, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Group)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
12	Shri Gautam Shelare, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (Group)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
13	Shri Ravindra Keny, Assistant Commissioner of Customs (General)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
14	Shri Narendra Kannaujia, Superintendant of Customs (Technical Cell)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
15	Smt Manisha S. Jadhav, Superintendent of Customs (Export EnT)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai

16	Shri Etteari Himagiri, Examiner (Technical Cell)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
17	Shri Vishal Kumar, Preventive Officer (Export E&T)	Customs, ACC, Mumbai
	Name of attendees of Stakeholders	**Organization**
1	Shri Hiren Joshi, Deputy Task Manager	AIASL
2	VP. Salunke, Executive Operations	AIASL
3	Shri Robin Fernandes, Operations Manager	Cathay Pacific Airlines
4	Shri Kaushal Thakker, Chairman Import	BCBA
5	Shri Paresh Sangari, Chairman PGA	BCBA
6	Shri Ketan Desai, Secretary	BCBA
7	Shri Sanjeev Harale, President	BCBA
8	Shri Shailesh Sharma, Secretary	ACAAI
9	Shri Mahesh Bowlay, Sr. Manager	MIAL
10	Shri Amit Kadam, Associate Manager	MIAL
11	Shri Subodh Thakur, Manager	MIAL
12	Shri Harish Zade, Supervisor	Lufthansa Cargo
13	Shri. Jayachandra.A, General Manager Operations	CSC
14	Lynn Boothello, Operations Manager	British Airways
15	Shri Gokul Ram, Plant Protection Officer	PQ
16	Naresh Kumar, Deputy Manager	MIAL
17	Newton Fernandes, Operations Manager	ANA
18	Sudhir Manipur, Manager Operations	Uganda Airlines
19	Shri Irshad Sayyed, Executive Operations	CI(ATC)
20	Shri Atish Hirve, Deputy Manager	Sequel One
21	Smt Jitha KK, Joint Director	FSSAI
22	Shri VA Shinde, Technical Officer	CDSCO

Representatives of Animal Quarantine (AQ) and Wildlife Crime Control Bureau (WCCB) did not attend the PTFC Meeting.

The Principal Commissioner of Customs (Import) welcomed all the attendees. The following agenda points were taken up.

1. Damage to import consignment during monsoon at Air India Warehouse:

This point was raised by BCBA that despite prior instructions and reminders in earlier PTFC meetings regarding precautionary measures to be taken during the monsoon season, several import consignments were found wet and damaged at the Air India warehouse. Such incidents are causing substantial losses to importers post-clearance. The Custodian is requested to take the matter seriously and ensure that import packages are stored and delivered in a safe and secure condition.

Discussions and decisions:

The representative of AISL Shri Hiren Joshi informed that some consignments may have been affected by the recent incessant rains and heavy monsoon, and confirmed the possibility of leakages within the AISL shed. They further stated that a dedicated vendor has been appointed to undertake and complete the waterproofing of the Warehouse. Principal Commissioner acknowledged the seriousness of the issue and advised the AISL representative to ensure that all necessary repairs are carried out promptly to safeguard the goods stored in the warehouse. The Chair emphasized that the safety of cargo must remain a top priority and instructed the AISL representative to give urgent attention to completing the repair and waterproofing work without further delay. As the issue has been discussed in earlier PTFC meetings also Pr. Commissioner inquired whether the matter is escalated to Air India higher authorities to which Shri Hiren Joshi replied in the affirmative.

The Chair has decided to keep the point open for the next PTFC meeting.

(Point Open)

Action : AISL

2. Issues faced with MIAL's OTP-based login system for payment:

BCBA has raised this point and informed that MIAL has introduced an OTP-based login for payment of charges. However, the trade has been facing significant delays, as OTPs are either not generated promptly or expire before use. Since username and password authentication is already mandatory, this additional OTP step is creating unnecessary delays in import clearances. They request that MIAL consider withdrawing the OTP-based login requirement and revert to the earlier system to facilitate operations.

Discussion and decision:

The representative of MIAL Shri Mahesh Bowlay informed that in view of the previous malware attack on their software, the OTP (One-Time Password) verification process has been implemented by their Adani IT team as an essential security measure to prevent unauthorized access and protect sensitive data. While this additional step may cause some inconvenience, it is a necessary safeguard to protect the System against potential threats. The OTP is typically valid for 15 minutes from the time of generation. Efforts are currently underway to streamline and optimize this process, but any changes will require the continued cooperation and support of the trade community to ensure both efficiency and security. Trade holders can also utilise e-mail OTP and add e-mail feature.

The Chair has decided to close this point.

(Point Closed)

Action: MIAL

3. Delay in Acceptance of LUT Bond for ADVANCE LICENSE after OMS Gate:

The point was raised by BCBA that while uploading documents in the OMS Gate, there has been a considerable delay in their acceptance. During the previous PTFC Meeting, BCBA had requested a review of the acceptance procedure, and they again requested that this be addressed in the interest of ease of doing business.

Discussion and decision:

The Commissioner (Export) has informed that initially the delay was due to administrative reasons such as transfer of DEEC registration files after the relieving of the earlier officer, and time taken for OMS Gate mapping/transfer of files to the newly joined Assistant Commissioner. In addition, delays were also noticed on account of incorrect/blurred/non-colored submission of documents by trade, which made verification difficult. The delay is regretted. The process being followed has been streamlined, and necessary steps are being taken to avoid recurrence, ensuring facilitation of trade.

Additionally, the Commissioner (Export) has instructed both the Trade and the officers to design a flowchart for OMS Gateway (Zone III) step by step and compare the same with the OMS Gateway System (Zone-II) so that redundant steps wherever unnecessary may be eliminated and streamlined OMS system from Zone II may be replicated in Zone III, ensuring uniformity and enhancing the effectiveness of operations.

The Chair has decided to close the point.

(Point: Closed)

Action: Export Commissionerate & BCBA

4. Increase in Log Entries due to non-tracing of packages:

This point was raised by BCBA that due to the sudden increase in the volume of cargo, there has been a considerable increase in LOG ENTIRES resulting in increase of Dwell Times and therefore Custodian is requested to increase their man-power. Custodian is also requested to devise new plan / strategy to handle the situation.

Discussion and decision

The representative of MIAL informed that the increased log entries and Dwell Times has been acknowledged, and the concern is well understood. It is agreed that the surge in cargo volume—particularly due to two consecutive holidays—contributed to the delays. This situation was recently experienced, and the impact it had has been recognized.

To manage such situations more efficiently in the future, manpower and the tracing team have already been increased following the 2nd Saturday and the festival holiday. A

supervisory staff from MIAL will be appointed to monitor the situation on a regular basis, ensuring that service continuity is maintained and whenever necessary additional staff will be deployed to handle these situations promptly. It is expected that these measures will result in reduced delays and improved overall handling.

The Chair has decided to close this point.

(Point Closed)

Action: MIAL

5. Faster NOC for FSSAI:

BCBA has stated that after uploading of documents on the FSSAI Portal, if there is any deficiency then the same is received at the end of the day resulting in lapsing of the entire day, Therefore it is requested that FSSAI Department in ACC to raise a query within 2-3 hours after the initial documents are uploaded so that the same can be addressed & resolved in timely manner resulting in quicker NOC's.

Discussion and decision:

The representative of FSSAI Ms. Jitha KK informed that nearly all new applications submitted by importers or CBs in the FICS portal of FSSAI are processed on the same day. Depending on the nature of the application, they are either:

i) accepted for payment to initiate the process of sampling and testing,

ii) issued an 'Out of Scope' report if the imported item does not fall under the purview of FSSAI,or

iii) returned to the importer/CHA for clarification in case of deficiencies or inaccuracies in the submitted documents or information.

Priority is also being given to applications for consignments that have already arrived at the airport, regardless of the nature of the articles contained.

The FSSAI representative informed that many of the queries raised are repetitive in nature. The trade is therefore requested to take note of these recurring issues and sensitize the personnel responsible for submitting documents on the FICS portal, in order to minimize such queries.

Additionally, the trade is advised to submit the required documents immediately upon receiving the system-generated confirmation email or message related to the Bill of Entry. Timely submission will allow for early scrutiny and processing of applications—potentially even before the consignment arrives at the airport—thereby helping to avoid delays. The representative also suggested organizing a training session for the trade to streamline the process of online document submission and further reduce dwell time. Pr. Commissioner said that Customs will coordinate and organise this session. Shri Kaushal Thakker, Chairman Import, BCBA, will be made part of the digital messaging group created by Customs with all

PGA representatives as members so that faster NOC's can be pursued with the concerned PGA.

The Chair has decided to close this point.

(Point Closed)

Action : FSSAI & BCBA

6. The representatives of Lufthansa and Air India raised IGM amendment issues :

Pr. Commissioner advised to submit a writeup along with case studies.

Action: Airlines Representative

The meeting ending after the foregoing discussions.

This issues with the approval of the Principal Commissioner of Customs, Import, ACC, Mumbai – III.

Digitally signed by Tagadi Manjunath
Date: 02-09-2025 17:46:54

(Tagadi Manjunath)
Additional Commissioner of Customs,
Import, ACC, Mumbai - III

Copy :-

1. Pr. Commissioner/ Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General, ACC.
2. All Addl./JC Commissioner of Customs, Import/Export/General/Pr.CCO, ACC.
3. All member of PTFC meeting including BCBA & ACAAI (via e-mail).
4. DC/EDI for uploading on ACC website (via e-mail).
5. PGAs, ACC Mumbai (via e-mail).
6. Office copy.